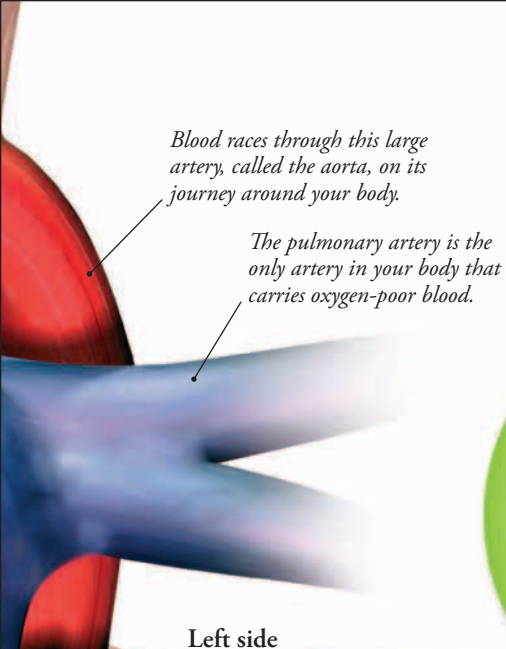




Left side

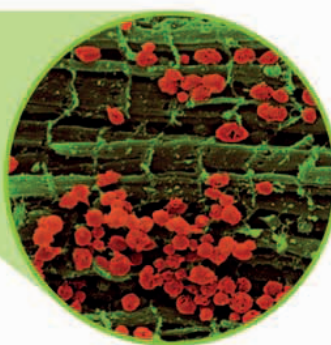
WOW!

Each day,
enough power is
produced in the
heart to drive a car
20 miles (32 km).

Blood from your lungs
enters through these
pulmonary veins.

Left atrium

The left ventricle has a thicker
muscular wall because it has to
pump blood farther than the
right ventricle.



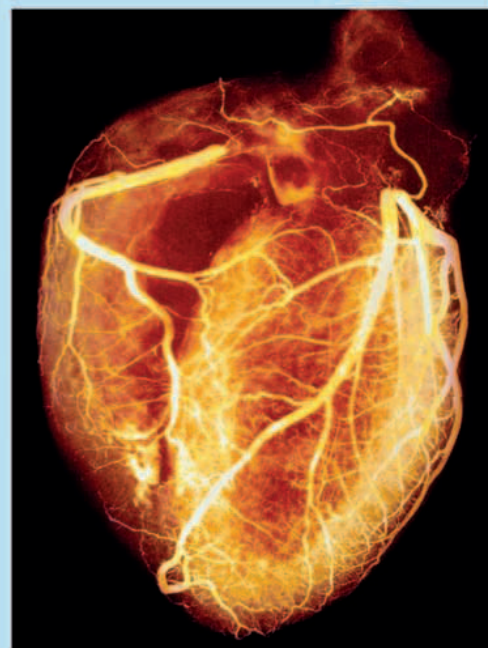
A wall of muscle divides
the heart into right
and left halves.

This tough double
membrane surrounds
and protects the heart.



LOOK CLOSER: BLOOD SUPPLY

Hardworking cardiac muscle cells demand constant supplies of food and oxygen to give them the energy needed to keep the heart beating. However, these cannot be supplied by the blood gushing through the heart. Instead, the heart has its own special network of blood vessels to supply its needs.



▲ **ANGIOGRAM** This special type of X-ray shows the main blood vessels, called coronary arteries, that supply the heart's muscular wall with blood.

◀ **CARDIAC MUSCLE** The thick walls of the heart are made with cardiac muscle cells (green). These are packed with mitochondria (red), which supply the heart's muscle cells with the energy they need to keep on beating.

FAST FACTS

- The first heartbeat happens during the fourth week of pregnancy, when the baby is no bigger than the size of your fingernail.
- The heart is the first organ to receive oxygen-rich blood.
- On average, an adult heart beats about 70 times a minute, when at rest.